



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Praise Academy at Lakeside
School Website: <http://praiselakeside.org>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Praise Academy Lakeside (Lakeside, LA 71103) presents clear Christian orientation in its public-facing materials, with emphasis on literature, mathematics, science, and fine arts. The site conveys a character-formation emphasis through biblical framing (e.g., "A Neighborhood Christian School" and references to God and scripture). However, explicit classical-grounded elements such as a formal Great Books program, a stated Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, a "living curriculum," or an explicit partnership framework with parents are not clearly evidenced on the public materials that address curriculum structure, pedagogy, or community engagement. Using the Six Essential Elements rubric (with positive/negative keyword indicators) as a lens, the school demonstrates some classical orientation (especially in religious/metaphysical tone and some curricular emphasis) but does not consistently meet the core criteria across all six categories. Overall, Praise Academy Lakeside falls into the category: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights - Strong religious framing is evident and pervasive (Christian school identity; biblical reference). This aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category in part, but there is limited explicit attestation to specific classical metaphysical theses in the public materials beyond a Christian worldview. - The curriculum speakers emphasize Great Literature (imagination) and solid Math/Science and Fine Arts, which hints at some classical elements (especially in curricular emphasis on beauty and literature). However, there is no explicit articulation of the Trivium/Quadrivium framework, Great Books program, or explicit Great Conversation language in public materials. - Pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement practices are not clearly described in classical terms (e.g., Socratic seminars, living curriculum, parent co-education). Therefore, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community categories do not demonstrate strong classical signals in the available public materials. - The aggregate assessment is therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with room to advance toward CLASSICAL through explicit articulation and implementation of core classical elements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents Praise Academy as "A Neighborhood Christian School," signaling a theological orientation to education and formation through a Christian worldview. The public materials also include biblical reference (e.g., Matthew 5:16) and a faith-based framing of education. This aligns with a transcendent moral realism and the role of theology in schooling.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed in public materials: Christian, God, Matthew 5:16, theology (implied by the Christian framing), sacred / worship language is not explicitly spelled out on the publicly indexed pages but is suggested by the biblical framing. - Negative keywords observed: none in the public materials. No explicit secular or relativistic signals evident.

Why this rating - The presence of a Christian identity and explicit biblical reference indicates engagement with religious/metaphysical foundations (transcendental ideals, theological framing). This supports a CLASSICAL orientation in this category.

Citations - Praise Academy Lakeside identifies as “A Neighborhood Christian School.” - The site features a biblical reference (Matthew 5:16). - Public materials emphasize literature and arts within a faith context (Great Literature; beauty; arts). - The classical lexicon and rubric emphasize the religious/theological dimension among positive signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes formation through literature, mathematics, science, and the arts, with a clear aim to cultivate imagination and perhaps virtue through education framed by Christian values. However, explicit statements about formation of character, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, or a telos oriented to human excellence are not openly stated in the public content as a formal, doctrinal aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: wonder, beauty, imagination (implied via Great Literature and Fine Arts emphasis), formation and character are not explicitly named but implied through a faith-based formation frame. - Negative keywords observed: none explicit in the public content. - The lexicon highlights formation, virtue, liberal education, scholé, great conversation, and the true/good/beautiful as core aims. Public content touches on formation through literature/arts but does not explicitly proclaim virtue formation or teleology in the classical sense.

Why this rating - The school shows a formation-oriented ethos and a pursuit of higher human goods (literature, beauty, virtue) in religious framing, but it does not explicitly articulate the classical teleology, the tria keys of virtue-formation, or the explicit classical purpose statements beyond a faith-based orientation. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations - Great Literature and arts emphasis (implied formation through literature and beauty). - Christian framing and biblical language suggest formation anchored in virtue within a faith tradition. - The Six Elements rubric and lexicon provide the canonical signals for purpose/goal (formation, true/good/beautiful).
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Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum signals visible on public pages include “Great Literature that engages the imagination,” “Strong Math and Science Curriculum,” and a “Fine Arts Program to cultivate beauty, music, and art.” This indicates a literature-centric and well-rounded curriculum with emphasis on aesthetics and sciences, echoing classical themes of liberal arts and culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Great Literature (interpreted as Great Books), beauty, arts, music, math/science (components of liberal education); language of “imagination” aligns with the classical emphasis on wonder and cultivation of intellect. - Negative keywords observed: absence of explicit mentions of grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books program, or a formal Trivium/Quadrivium sequence; no explicit reference to Great Conversations or primary classical texts; no Latin/Greek language emphasis. The public materials do not show history-as-Western civilizational chronology in the curriculum; history content is not explicit.

Why this rating - The presence of Great Literature and a robust math/science and arts program signals alignment with some classical curricular elements, but the absence of explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation, Great Books/Great Conversation, and core liberal arts language means it does not fully meet the classical curriculum criteria. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Great Literature that engages the imagination; Strong Math and Science Curriculum; Fine Arts Program. - The presence of classical-curriculum signals (wording from the Six Elements lexicon as reference) but without explicit Trivium/Quadrivium mentions in public content.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not describe Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussion, rigorous Socratic pedagogy, or a strong emphasis on scholé (restful learning) in the lower or upper school. The site highlights

literature, math/science, and arts but does not provide explicit teaching methods pointing to strict classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords would include: Socratic dialogue; narration; memory work; scholé; contemplative pedagogy; rhetorical training; memory-based learning. None of these are explicitly present in the public content. - Negative keyword signals: Not explicitly present as negative signals; however, the absence of classical pedagogical signals within the public content is the determining factor, resulting in an absence of positive signals in this category.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit classical pedagogical signals (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/chanting, rhetoric training) leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy from the available public materials.

Citations - Public site content shows curricular emphasis but no explicit classical pedagogy signals (no Socratic seminars, no scholé statements).

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is no explicit public material describing faculty as “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” or “portrait of a teacher,” nor any statement about faculty as mentors or a collegial community in the classical sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive/classical keywords include: model teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as mentors; collegial culture. None of these are evidenced in the public content. - Negative keywords (signals of lack) would be: “teacher as guide on the side” or non-classical professional language. None of these are explicitly stated either, but the absence of classical faculty language counts as a lack of classical signals.

Why this rating - Without explicit descriptions of the faculty as role models, living curriculum, or a formal classical faculty identity, this category does not meet the classical standard based on available public materials.

Citations - Public site materials do not include a robust description of faculty as living curriculum or model teachers.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school site has general outreach (newsletter sign-up, “Ways to Help” pages), but there is no explicit articulation of parents as co-educators, partner formation with families, or a formal program of parent education or community liturgy. There is no explicit “parents as co-teachers” or “open campus” language on the public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords (from the Six Elements lexicon) include: partnership with parents; parent formation; classroom visits; parent education; liturgical learning; Scholé communities; family liturgy alignment. None appear explicitly in the public content of Praise Academy Lakeside. - Negative keywords: none explicit in the public content, but the absence of explicit parental partnership signals a lack in this category.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit parental co-educator language and structured community-partnership messaging leads to NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations - Public site content shows general outreach but not explicit parent/community classical signals (e.g., parent formation, co-teaching language).

Aggregate Assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

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- Curriculum: Adopt explicit Great Books / Great Conversation language with a formal Great Books program and a stated Trivium/Quadrivium pathway (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music). Publicly articulate the core liberal arts sequence and the rationale for them in the school's mission and curriculum pages.
 - Pedagogy: Introduce and publish classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussions, memory work/recitation, liturgical singing) and provide examples or case studies from the school to demonstrate implementation. Tie pedagogy to Scholé/restful learning as a daily practice.
 - Faculty: Publish a "living curriculum" portrait of teachers, describe teacher professional development in classical pedagogy, and emphasize mentorship/collegial culture as core to the faculty identity.
 - Parents & Community: Establish explicit parent-partnership language (parents as co-teachers, parental formation, family liturgy alignment) and open-campus policies so parents may regularly visit and participate in book studies or family-learning events.
 - Theology & Liturgical Practices: More clearly articulate liturgical or communal practices as part of daily or weekly rhythm, with explicit connection to the Great Conversation and classical aims (as appropriate to a Christian classical school context).
 - History and Cultural Transmission: Explicitly frame a Western-civilizational history strand with primary sources and a canon (Great Books) to ensure historical depth consistent with classical tradition, including language about cultural transmission and the imago Dei in education.

Citations - Evidence of current Christian framing and literature/arts emphasis is visible in Praise Academy Lakeside materials. - Great Literature and a broad curriculum emphasis are evidenced by the site content. - The Six Essential Elements lexicon (and related literature) defines the core categories and keywords used for evaluating classical alignment. □filecite□turn0file10□turn0file0□ - The Great Books/Great Conversation language is a core classical signal defined in the knowledge base.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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